

The 2026 Kenya Retail Relational Readiness Report

A Holistic Market Ingestion and Operational Signal Blueprint

FRAMEWORK

Minimum Viable Relationships (MVR)
Originated by Farouk Mark Mukilbi

PUBLICATION DATE

2026-05-29

PROTOCOL ENGINE

MVR Core API v6.32.0
Run label: v12 public-calibration rerun

DECISION SCOPE

Nairobi City County plus Kiambu
Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor

Release classification and conditions of use

This document is released as a **public strategic brief with an audit appendix**. It is an MVR evidence-readiness brief for strategic scoping and macro-environmental positioning. Reading it as anything more than that misstates what the engine returned.

THIS BRIEF IS

- A public strategic brief with an audit appendix.
- An MVR evidence-readiness assessment for strategic scoping and macro-environmental positioning.
- Bounded to evidence available as of May 2026 within the named corridor.

THIS BRIEF IS NOT

- Not investment advice.
- Not credit certification or credit approval.
- Not legal advice or regulatory approval / certification.
- Not a national Kenya rollout authorization.
- Not a substitute for formal due diligence.

Human review required

Engine evidence-completeness status `decision_ready` is not standalone authorization. Every downstream use of this brief requires human review and, where relevant, committee review.

The result is tied to the ingested evidence available as of May 2026 and to the Nairobi City County plus Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor. It should not be generalized to all Kenya retail or to any individual operator without additional operator-specific internal evidence. Raw records are retained in the African Market OS internal audit archive; external verification requires controlled access to the redacted evidence bundle, fieldwork instruments, source screenshots or archived pages, anonymized source registers, and the methodology appendix.

POST-RUN MACRO CONTEXT LABELLED

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

VERDICT: PILOT_ONLY

NOT AUTHORIZED FOR NATIONAL SCALE

INSIDE THIS BRIEF

Contents

01	Executive summary & verdict dashboard Full advisory and strict calibrated verdict, confidence, calibration, evidence status.
02	The central question
03	Why traditional retail analytics miss the real signal
04	What the engine ran Evidence architecture and the nine evidence layers.
05	Macroeconomic grounding & public stress context
06	Current public footprint calibration
07	The geofenced signal
08	What the verdict means & why the engine withholds scale
09	Market readiness vs operator readiness & the MVR ladder
10	Governance interpretation
11	Public decision interpretation & staged entry
12	What this means for investors, lenders and boards
13	Public source anchors
14	Audit appendix Engine I/O, claim-evidence map, sample methodology, contradiction & supersession log, scoring explanation.
15	Data integrity, disclaimer & commercial access
16	Closing insight

How to read this brief
The engine is not saying "Kenya retail is weak." It is saying the external market, corridor, distributor, farmer, regulatory, social, and informal-channel evidence can support a **bounded pilot**, while scale requires proof that the operator can execute. Every number, caveat, and source classification in this brief is carried unchanged from the underlying run.

The verdict, stated conservatively

EVIDENCE-READY FOR HUMAN-REVIEWED BOUNDED PILOT DILIGENCE

Kenya retail is evidence-ready for human-reviewed bounded pilot diligence in Nairobi City County and the Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor — and is not authorized for national scale.

VERDICT	STRICT CALIBRATED CONFIDENCE	EVIDENCE STATUS	GOVERNANCE
pilot_only	0.7718	decision_ready	human review required

African Market OS ran the MVR Core API against a multi-layer Kenya retail evidence pack to answer a commercially important question: **is Kenya retail relationally ready for scale, or only for bounded pilot deployment in specific corridors?** The answer remains conservative and board-safe. It is not authorized for national rollout, scale capital allocation, credit approval, regulatory certification, or an affirmative board recommendation to scale.

Full advisory and strict calibrated verdict

PROFILE	VERDICT	CONFIDENCE	CALIBRATION	EVIDENCE STATUS
Full advisory	pilot_only	0.35	heuristic provisional	decision_ready ; human review required
Strict calibrated	pilot_only	0.7718	empirically calibrated	decision_ready ; human review required

Terminology note

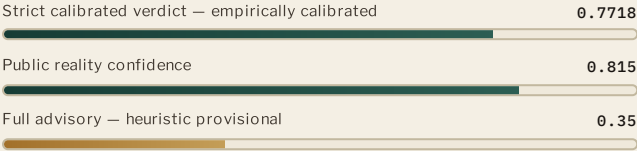
decision_ready is the engine's evidence-completeness status. Governance interpretation is narrower: the pack is evidence-ready for human-reviewed bounded pilot diligence, **not** authorized as a standalone basis for investment, credit approval without committee review, regulatory certification, or national scale.

The v12 public-calibration rerun added current public market signals around retailer footprints, PMI/inflation pressure, Nairobi retail real-estate constraints, and the cash/M-Pesa payment landscape. These additions improved the audit trail and corrected stale branch-footprint context. They did not change the final verdict, because the missing blocker is not more public market evidence — it is **authenticated internal operating evidence from the specific retail operator**.

Executive verdict dashboard

All figures below are reproduced exactly from the v12 run. Charts visualise only values already present in the brief; no values are added, inferred, or extrapolated.

Confidence & calibration



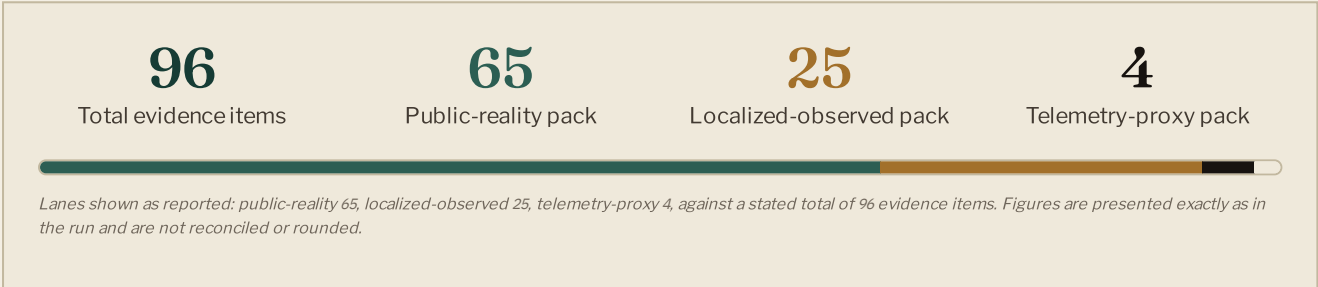
Two calibration paths are reported. Both return `pilot_only`; neither returns `ready_to_scale`.

Claim audit — v12



The claim audit is clean: every submitted claim is bound to evidence references.

Evidence pack composition



What the engine is — and is not — saying

The engine is not saying "Kenya retail is weak." It is saying the external market, corridor, distributor, farmer, regulatory, social, and informal-channel evidence can support a bounded pilot, while scale requires proof that the operator can execute.

THE QUESTION THIS BRIEF ANSWERS

Is Kenya retail relationally ready for scale, or only for bounded pilot deployment in specific corridors?

THE CONCISE ANSWER

Kenya retail is **evidence-ready for human-reviewed bounded pilot diligence** in Nairobi City County and the Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor. It is **not authorized** for national rollout, scale capital allocation, credit approval, regulatory certification, or an affirmative board recommendation to scale.

Result	Within	Governance
pilot_only	The authorized geofence only	human review required

Why traditional retail analytics miss the real signal

Kenya retail is not only a transaction system. It is a relational system. Retail execution depends on whether the people who carry the operating model will keep carrying it.

Traditional retail analysis in emerging and high-context markets often begins with household consumption, GDP growth, store counts, mall occupancy, or broad consumer sentiment. Those are useful indicators, but they are not enough. Execution depends on whether traders, farmers, wholesalers, transporters, regulators, county officials, informal-market actors, payment rails, landlords, distributors, customers, and local guardians will carry the operating model.

TRADITIONAL RETAIL ANALYTICS ASKS

Is there demand?

- GDP growth
- Household consumption
- Store counts
- Mall occupancy
- Broad consumer sentiment

MVR RELATIONAL ANALYTICS ASKS

Has the venture earned the right to operate?

- Trust
- Permission
- Embeddedness
- Reciprocity
- Continuity
- Local legitimacy
- Channel permission

The deeper question

Has the venture earned enough trust, permission, embeddedness, reciprocity, continuity, local legitimacy, and channel permission to operate without hidden relational failure?

This is the difference between ordinary retail intelligence and relational readiness. That is why this report uses the Minimum Viable Relationships framework, originated by Farouk Mark Mukiibi.

The evidence architecture

The run was designed as an ecosystem ingestion rather than a market-size exercise. The v12 evidence pack contains **96 evidence items** across public-reality, localized-observed, and telemetry-proxy lanes. The engine did not use a single broad proxy as the basis for the verdict. It reconciled multiple evidence lanes, then stress-tested the result against the MVR readiness ladder.



Diagram: schematic of the v12 evidence pipeline. Layer labels and sample sizes are reproduced from the brief; the diagram adds no quantities of its own.

The nine evidence layers

EVIDENCE LAYER	WHAT IT MEASURED	WHY IT MATTERS
Macro & administrative baselines	KNBS, KRA, CBK, EPRA, CA, PMI, and official sector context	Establishes whether the sector signal is real and current.
Household & merchant ground truth	Household survey design, merchant survey design, and physical retail audit design	Tests whether demand and trading behavior appear at the street and store level.
Distributor & logistics evidence	FMCG distributors, Eastleigh wholesalers, wet-market routes, port-to-shelf constraints, last-mile operators, B2B logistics SMEs	Detects whether goods can actually move through the corridor.
Informal-channel evidence	Duka, wet-market, mitumba, Eastleigh, market transport, cash-led trading, ledger credit	Captures the retail system that formal datasets often miss.
Farmer & supply-origin evidence	Weighted producer and cooperative evidence, sample n=150	Anchors upstream food and fresh-produce continuity.
Guardian & regulatory evidence	County, KRA, consumer-rights, and local guardian evidence, sample n=100	Tests permission, enforcement, and compliance friction.
Retail footprint evidence	Naivas, Carrefour, Quickmart, and related formal retail footprint refresh	Prevents stale branch-count assumptions from distorting the public market signal.
Payment & social telemetry	Cash, M-Pesa, PayBill/till, card, social listening, reputation, channel sentiment	Identifies adoption signals and invisible stress.
Claim-evidence map	Metadata ledger, source class, evidence IDs, and claim binding	Prevents unsupported or weakly supported claims from entering the final decision.

Method discipline

The engine did not use a single broad proxy as the basis for the verdict. It reconciled multiple evidence lanes, then stress-tested the result against the MVR readiness ladder.

Macroeconomic grounding

The report avoids treating broad household-consumption proxies as if they were retail-sector proof. The cleaned run uses sector-specific official context from the KNBS Economic Survey 2026 as represented in the claim-evidence map.

KSh 1.38T

OFFICIAL SOURCE

WHOLESALE & RETAIL TRADE GVA, 2025

Establishes a sector-specific formal retail and trade anchor.

7.8%

OFFICIAL SOURCE

GDP SHARE

Shows that retail and trade remain structurally important in the national economy.

3.6%

OFFICIAL SOURCE

REAL SUBSECTOR GROWTH

Indicates positive sector velocity, but not enough on its own to justify scale.

Caution

Macro attractiveness is not permission to scale.

MVR does not treat macro attractiveness as permission to scale. Macro strength can create opportunity, but relational readiness determines whether the opportunity can be safely entered.

The v12 rerun also adds public stress context — set out on the following page — covering PMI momentum, the official KNBS May 2026 inflation reading, retail real-estate oversupply pressure, and a dual-velocity cash / M-Pesa payment landscape. Context that arrived after the scored engine run is labelled as such and presented as corroborating rather than scored input.

Public stress context

Signal cards below are public stress context added in v12. The May 2026 inflation reading is official KNBS data; the remaining cards are public-reported context. None were scored inputs to the original engine run and all are presented as corroborating macro-environmental context.

STANBIC / S&P KENYA PMI

PUBLIC-REPORTED

49.4

April 2026

47.7

March 2026

expansion threshold

Mar

Apr

Up from 47.7 in March but still below the expansion threshold.

OFFICIAL INFLATION — KNBS
MAY 2026

OFFICIAL / STATISTICAL

6.7%

May 2026 (KNBS, official)

5.6%

April 2026

The Kenya National Bureau of Statistics May 2026 CPI confirms annual consumer price inflation at 6.7%, up from 5.6% in April — its highest level since January 2024. The rise is driven by transport (+16.5%) on fuel-price hikes linked to the Middle East conflict, food and non-alcoholic beverages (+9.4%), and housing/utilities (+3.4%). This confirmed macro stress corroborates and reinforces the conservative **pilot_only** posture rather than weakening it.

RETAIL REAL-ESTATE PRESSURE

PUBLIC-REPORTED

Retail real-estate evidence continues to show **spatial oversupply pressure** in the Nairobi Metropolitan Area. This modifies site-selection risk but does not override the corridor **pilot_only** verdict.

CASH / M-PESA DUAL VELOCITY

PUBLIC-REPORTED

Payment evidence shows a **dual-velocity market**: cash remains important for daily transactions while M-Pesa and formal digital rails carry large-scale transaction value.

Macro stress now confirmed

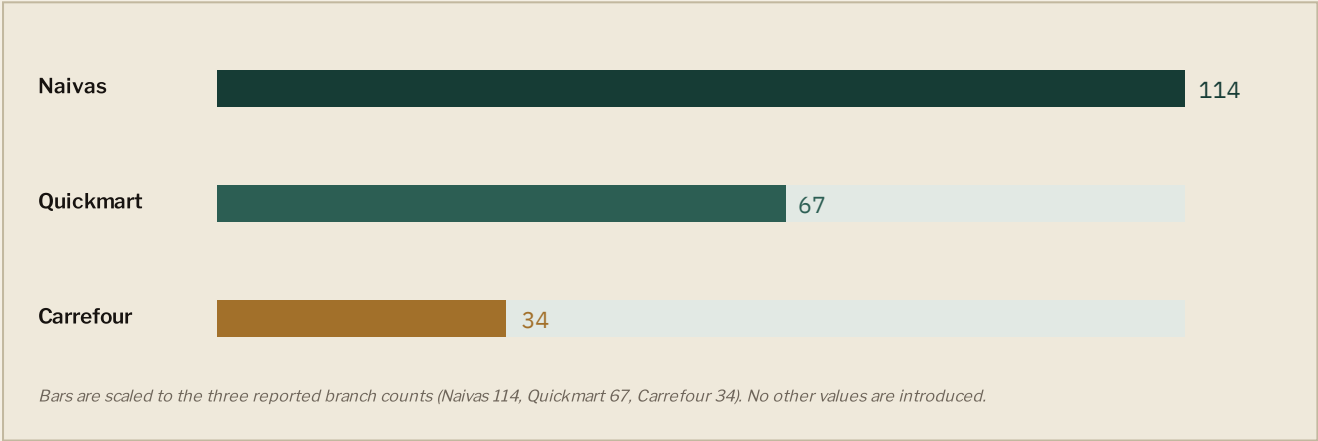
The May 2026 inflation reading is now official KNBS data rather than provisional context. It arrived after the scored engine run and is presented here as confirmed macro-environmental context; it corroborates the conditions behind the conservative verdict and reinforces why national scale remains blocked pending operator proof.

Current public footprint calibration

The reviewer correctly flagged that stale retail branch counts can distort market interpretation. The v12 rerun therefore refreshed current public footprint anchors.

RETAILER	CURRENT PUBLIC FOOTPRINT SIGNAL USED IN V12	HOW IT IS USED
Naivas OPERATOR-OFFICIAL	114 branches, with Ruaka as the latest public branch signal	Public footprint context only.
Carrefour Kenya PUBLIC-REPORTED	34 stores nationwide as of May 2026 public reporting	Public footprint context only.
Quickmart PUBLIC-REPORTED	67 branches after the April 2026 Elgon View opening	Supersedes the older 63-store late-2025 claim for current branch-footprint context.

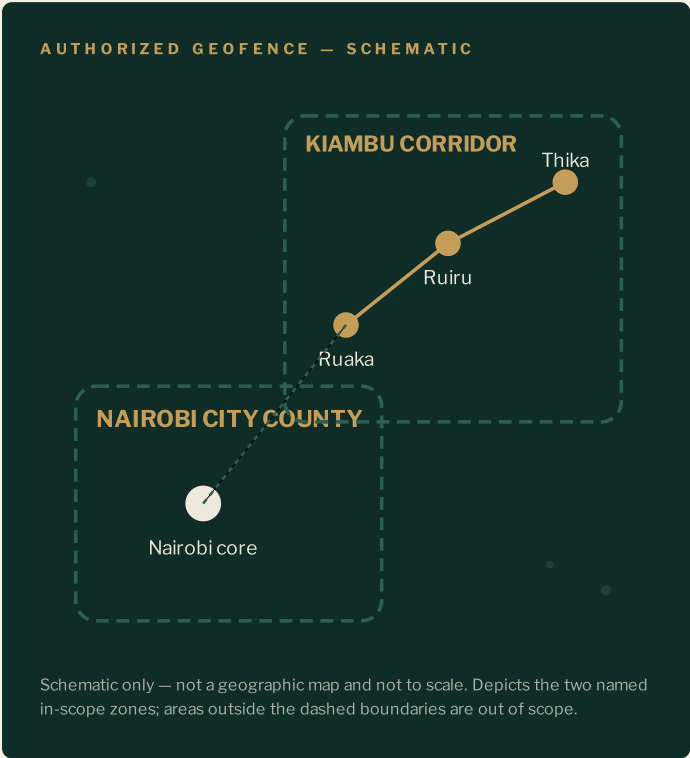
Public footprint signal — branch counts used in v12



Footprint does not equal readiness
These figures do not prove operator readiness. They help calibrate public market structure. They do not supply internal branch P&L, inventory accuracy, warehouse fill rate, eTIMS success rate, or SOP compliance.

The geofenced signal

The cleanest readiness signal is corridor-specific, not national. The engine found sufficient evidence for a controlled pilot posture in two bounded zones only.



SUFFICIENT EVIDENCE FOR A CONTROLLED PILOT IN

- Nairobi City County.
- Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor.

Within these zones, the evidence base shows stronger alignment across consumer density, distributor depth, payment context, farmer supply continuity, regulatory visibility, informal-channel reach, and corridor logistics.

Result
`pilot_only` within the authorized geofence.

This is not a national Kenya authorization
It is not a national Kenya retail authorization, a Mombasa authorization, a Nakuru authorization, a Kisumu authorization, an Eldoret/Uasin Gishu authorization, an ASAL or rural-corridor authorization, or a scale recommendation. Those regions require separate corridor runs before capital or operational conclusions can be extended.

What the verdict authorizes — and what it does not

A decision-authority guardrail keeps the verdict inside its evidentiary limits. The public verdict in this brief is based on the /v1/decision-check outputs.

AUTHORIZED

WITHIN GEOFENCE

- Bounded pilot diligence** in Nairobi City County and the Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor — subject to human review.

NOT AUTHORIZED

GUARDRAIL

- National rollout.
- Scale capital allocation.
- Credit approval.
- Regulatory certification.
- An affirmative board recommendation to scale.

DECISION AUTHORITY GUARDRAIL	STATUS
Bounded pilot diligence within the geofence (human-reviewed)	AUTHORIZED
National Kenya rollout	NOT AUTHORIZED
Scale capital allocation	NOT AUTHORIZED
Credit approval	NOT AUTHORIZED
Regulatory certification	NOT AUTHORIZED
Affirmative board recommendation to scale	NOT AUTHORIZED

Decision authority note: the public verdict in this brief is based on the /v1/decision-check outputs. The /v1/report-pack artifact is release-safe, but its report-layer field may remain `recommended_decision: undetermined` ; it does not independently override the decision-check verdict.

Why the engine withholds scale

MARKET-SIDE EVIDENCE — SUFFICIENT FOR PILOT

The market-side evidence is now strong enough to support a bounded pilot: corridor, distributor, farmer, regulatory, social, and informal-channel evidence align within the geofence.

OPERATOR-SIDE EVIDENCE — MISSING FOR SCALE

The MVR engine withholds a scale recommendation because it was not given authenticated internal operating evidence for the specific retail operator.

The missing internal operating layer

INTERNAL OPERATING VARIABLE	WHY IT MATTERS
Branch SOP compliance	Shows whether stores actually execute the operating model.
Inventory accuracy by branch	Shows whether ERP/POS stock truth matches physical stock.
Warehouse fill rate	Shows whether the network can replenish branches reliably.
Stockout resolution time	Shows whether lost sales and service gaps can be corrected quickly.
eTIMS invoice success rate	Shows whether KRA fiscalization works consistently at branch level.
Cash reconciliation controls	Shows whether tills, M-Pesa, card settlements, and bank deposits reconcile.
Supplier payment discipline	Shows whether suppliers are likely to continue supporting the operator.
Working capital position	Shows whether the pilot has liquidity coverage inside the authorized corridor.
Pilot branch P&L	Shows whether unit economics work before central overhead assumptions.
Staff attendance and turnover	Shows whether store-level execution can remain stable.
Store manager cadence	Shows whether management reviews and corrective actions actually occur.
Internal audit findings	Shows whether high-risk operational issues are closed.
Board reporting cadence	Shows whether governance oversight is real and current.

This is not a defect in the model. It is the reason the model is useful. A less disciplined system might convert a strong macro and corridor signal into a scale recommendation. MVR refuses to do that until the operator proves it can execute.

Market readiness is not the same as operator readiness.

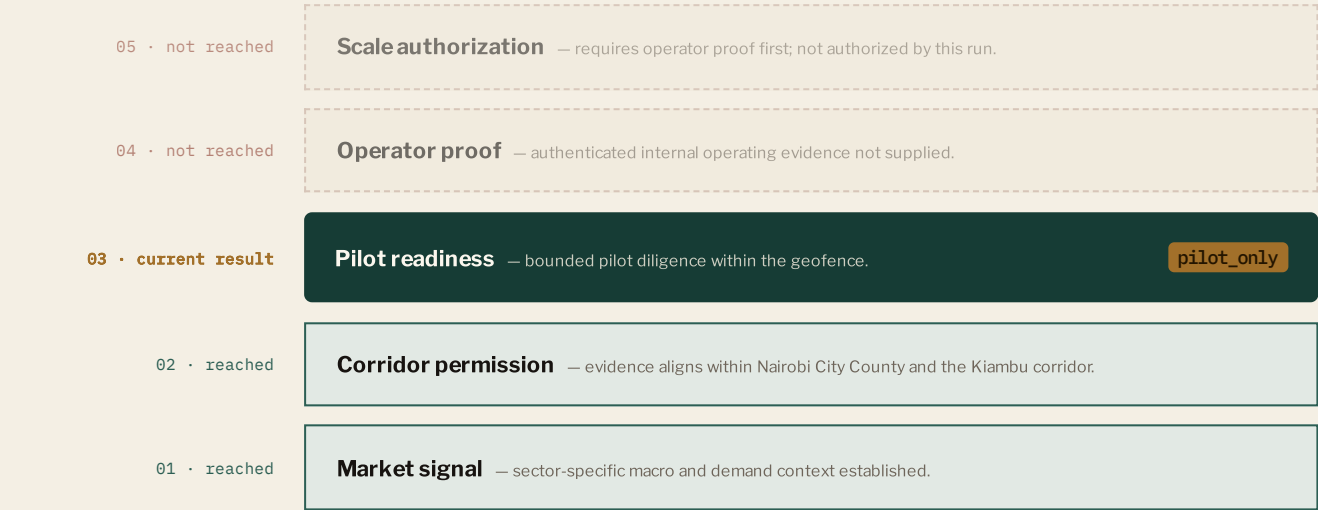
Opportunity is not readiness. Readiness is not scale.



The MVR distinction
Opportunity is not readiness, and readiness is not scale until the relationships and operations both hold.

The MVR readiness ladder

The engine reconciled multiple evidence lanes, then stress-tested the result against the MVR readiness ladder. The current result stops at **pilot readiness**. The two highest rungs — operator proof and scale authorization — are not reached, because authenticated internal operating evidence was not supplied.



Where the result stops
The current result stops at pilot readiness. The market may be ready to test; the operator must still prove it can execute before the ladder advances to operator proof and scale authorization.

The ladder is a presentation of the report's own maturity logic; rung positions reflect the run's stated result (**pilot_only** , scale withheld pending operator evidence) and add no new scoring.

Governance interpretation

`decision_ready` is evidence-completeness language. It is not standalone authorization.

WHAT THE ENGINE MEANS BY IT

`decision_ready` is the engine's evidence-completeness status — a statement that the pack is complete enough to support a human decision process, not a statement that a decision has been authorized.

THE GOVERNANCE READING

The pack is evidence-ready for human-reviewed bounded pilot diligence — **not** authorized as a standalone basis for investment, credit approval without committee review, regulatory certification, or national scale.

Human review required

No output in this brief is a substitute for human review. Every downstream decision — capital, credit, regulatory, or board — requires human, and where relevant committee, review before action.

In board language, the disciplined reading is direct: **proceed to bounded pilot diligence; do not approve national rollout or scale capital on this report alone.**

SECTION 11

11

Public decision interpretation

Kenya retail, as observed through the Nairobi/Kiambu evidence corridor, is ready for a controlled pilot, but not ready for unqualified scale authorization.

A responsible retail, investor, lender, accelerator, or corporate strategy team should treat this as a blueprint for staged entry — not as a green light to scale.

A blueprint for staged entry

- 01 Run a bounded pilot in Nairobi City County and the Kiambu Ruaka–Ruiru–Thika corridor.
- 02 Bind every material claim to source-class evidence.
- 03 Add internal operations evidence from the operator's ERP, POS, WMS, finance, HR, audit, and board systems.
- 04 Re-run MVR once internal controls are populated.
- 05 Run each additional geography separately before expanding.

In one line

The market can be tested. The operator must still prove it can execute.

What this means for investors, lenders, and boards

The report supports a cautious strategic signal — explicitly staged, and explicitly bounded to the corridor.

- The Nairobi/Kiambu corridor has enough relational and market evidence for controlled pilot planning.
- The v12 claim audit is clean: 24 claims supported, 0 unsupported claims, 0 weakly supported claims.
- The strict calibrated verdict remains `pilot_only` , not `ready_to_scale` .
- Capital allocation should remain staged until internal operating proof is supplied.
- National expansion should not be approved from this corridor result alone.

24 CLAIMS SUPPORTED	0 UNSUPPORTED CLAIMS	0 WEAKLY SUPPORTED
---	--	--

IN BOARD LANGUAGE

Proceed to bounded pilot diligence. Do not approve national rollout or scale capital on this report alone.

Public source anchors

Public source anchors used for the v12 refresh, with source classification preserved. Naivas is treated as operator-official; Carrefour and Quickmart are treated as public-reported footprint anchors unless an operator-owned page or signed source pack is attached.

ANCHOR	PUBLIC REFERENCE	CLASSIFICATION
Naivas official public footprint	corporate.naivas.info/about/	OPERATOR-OFFICIAL
Carrefour Kenya 34-store reporting	standardmedia.co.ke/business/.../2001548838	PUBLIC-REPORTED
Quickmart 67th branch reporting	eldoretleo.co.ke/quickmart-opens-67th-branch...	MEDIA-REPORTED
Quickmart 67th branch — secondary	foodbusinessmea.com/quickmart-opens-67th-branch...	MEDIA-REPORTED
Stanbic/S&P Kenya PMI, April 2026	pmi.spglobal.com/Public/Home/PressRelease/...	OFFICIAL / STATISTICAL
KNBS CPI & inflation release	knbs.or.ke/reports_category/cpi-and-inflation-rates/	OFFICIAL / STATISTICAL
Cytonn Kenya Retail Report	cytonnreport.com/research/kenya-retail-report	THIRD-PARTY REPORT
FinAccess household survey material	fsdkenya.org	OFFICIAL / STATISTICAL
M-Pesa transaction-scale reporting	businessnewskenya.com/.../safaricom-says-m-pesa-kadogo...	MEDIA-REPORTED

- OPERATOR-OFFICIAL
- PUBLIC-REPORTED / THIRD-PARTY REPORT
- OFFICIAL / STATISTICAL
- MEDIA-REPORTED
- INTERNAL EVIDENCE RETAINED
- TELEMETRY-PROXY

Verify the public sources

Full public source links and archived source notes: africanmarketos.com/research/kenya-retail-2026/sources. Anchor URLs above are clickable and shown in shortened form for layout; the full links resolve to the same public references.

Archived snapshots for key public anchors are retained in the African Market OS internal audit archive and are available for controlled review where appropriate. Naivas is treated as operator-official; Carrefour and Quickmart are treated as public-reported footprint anchors unless an operator-owned page or signed source pack is attached.

Engine input / output summary

The verdict in this brief is reproducible from the engine run below. Figures are reported exactly as returned by the MVR Core API v12 public-calibration rerun; no value has been adjusted for presentation.

96

EVIDENCE ITEMS

65

PUBLIC-REALITY PACK

25

LOCALIZED-OBSERVED PACK

4

TELEMETRY-PROXY PACK

Pack composition is reported as returned by the engine: the public-reality, localized-observed, and telemetry-proxy packs sum to 94, while the total evidence-item count is stated as 96. Both figures are presented exactly as in the source run and are not reconciled in this public brief.

ENGINE FIELD	RESULT
Full advisory verdict	<code>pilot_only</code> · confidence 0.35
Strict calibrated verdict	<code>pilot_only</code> · confidence 0.7718
Public-reality confidence	0.815
Calibration status	<code>empirically_calibrated</code>
Evidence completeness	<code>decision_ready</code>
Supported claims	24
Unsupported claims	0
Weakly supported claims	0

Strict evidence-audit limitation — disclosed

The strict evidence-audit utility route still returns:

`insufficient_calibration: evidence-audit requires a certified anomaly-detection model` .

The claim audit is clean. The strict evidence-audit utility remains unavailable pending certified anomaly-detection calibration. This route-specific strict-audit limitation does not invalidate the strict decision-check result, but it remains disclosed.

Decision authority note

The public verdict in this brief is based on the `/v1/decision-check` outputs. The `/v1/report-pack` artifact is release-safe, but its report-layer field may remain `recommended_decision: undetermined` ; it does not independently override the decision-check verdict.

Claim-evidence map & methodology

B · Claim-evidence map summary

The public-facing v12 claim audit binds all submitted claims to evidence references. Key updated bindings include:

CLAIM AREA	V12 EVIDENCE BINDING
Quickmart current branch footprint	EV-v12-CURRENT-RETAIL-FOOTPRINTS-2026
Naivas, Carrefour, Quickmart public footprint anchors	EV-v12-CURRENT-RETAIL-FOOTPRINTS-2026
KNBS Wholesale & Retail Trade GVA	EV-v11-CLAIM-ANCHOR-KNBS-TRADE-GVA-2025
Nairobi/Kiambu target-zone GCP context	EV-v11-CLAIM-ANCHOR-KNBS-GCP-TARGET-ZONES
Retail real-estate oversupply / spatial constraint	EV-v12-SPATIAL-REAL-ESTATE-CONSTRAINTS-NMA
PMI / inflation stress	EV-v12-MACRO-PMI-INFLATION-SHOCK-2026
Cash / M-Pesa payment duality	EV-v12-PAYMENT-DUAL-VELOCITY-CASH-MPESA

The detailed machine-readable summary is retained in the African Market OS internal audit archive and is available for controlled review where appropriate.

C · Sample methodology summary

The run combines the following evidence designs. These evaluate market and relational readiness; they are not a substitute for internal operator evidence.

Household survey design	n=2,000 · effective 1,360
Merchant survey design	n=1,200
Retail audit design	45 nodes
Distributor / logistics expansion (weighted)	n=174
Informal-channel logistics (weighted)	n=52
Farmer / smallholder supply-origin (weighted)	n=150
Guardian / regulatory evidence (weighted)	n=100
Public & consented social-listening layer	12,000 deduplicated mentions

Data integrity & privacy

All survey, telemetry, and social-listening evidence used in this public brief is presented only in aggregated or redacted form; no personally identifiable respondent or merchant data is disclosed.

Supersession log & scoring

D · Contradiction and supersession log

The v12 public-calibration rerun corrects or constrains these potential contradictions:

- The older Quickmart 63-store late-2025 claim is retained only as historical corridor context; current public footprint uses the April 2026 67-store signal.
- Broad HFCE macro context is not used as a retail market-size authorization.
- The reconciled public benchmark for the food/grocery-related retail opportunity is treated as a bounded proxy, not a complete national retail valuation. The prior speculative USD **56.4B** inference is superseded; the safer USD **18.1B** benchmark combines Euromonitor/USDA category baselines and should not be used as a full Kenya retail market size unless category overlap is separately reconciled.
- National Kenya indicators are not treated as national rollout authorization.
- Mombasa, Nakuru, Kisumu, Eldoret/Uasin Gishu, and ASAL/rural corridors remain out of scope.
- Public branch counts do not imply internal execution readiness.
- Retail real-estate oversupply modifies site-selection risk but does not override the corridor `pilot_only` verdict.

E · Scoring explanation

The final result is produced by reconciling public reality with localized relational evidence. In the v12 strict calibrated path:

- Public reality is empirically calibrated and observed, but it is not sufficient to authorize scale.
- Localized relational assessment is available and drives the bounded pilot signal.
- The dominant failure mode remains evidence scope and missing internal operator proof.
- The engine returns `pilot_only` because the market can be tested, but not scaled without internal operating evidence.

Disclaimer & commercial access

Public disclaimer

This document is an MVR evidence-readiness brief for strategic scoping and macro-environmental positioning. It is **not investment advice, credit certification, legal advice, regulatory approval, or a substitute for formal due diligence.**

The result is tied to the ingested evidence available as of May 2026 and to the Nairobi City County plus Kiambu Ruaka-Ruiru-Thika corridor. It should not be generalized to all Kenya retail or to any individual operator without additional operator-specific internal evidence.

Raw records are retained in the African Market OS internal audit archive. External verification requires controlled access to the redacted evidence bundle, fieldwork instruments, source screenshots or archived pages, anonymized source registers, and the methodology appendix.

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

NOT A SCALE AUTHORIZATION

NOT NATIONAL ROLLOUT

Commercial access

The Minimum Viable Relationships framework defines what to assess. The MVR API is the official engine that computes it. African Market OS can run licensed corridor studies, enterprise evidence audits, internal operations ingestion, MVR-Bench evaluation, and agent-ready market-readiness workflows.

FOR ACCESS

API key	africanmarketos.com/get-api-key
Pricing	africanmarketos.com/pricing
Contact	info@africanmarketos.com

FOR AI AGENTS & DEVELOPERS

OpenAPI	africanmarketos.com/api/openapi.json
MCP	africanmarketos.com/mcp
MVR-Bench	africanmarketos.com/benchmarks/mvr-bench/

FINAL PUBLIC VERDICT

Kenya retail has opportunity.
Nairobi/Kiambu has enough relational
signal for a bounded pilot.
Scale still requires operator proof.

*Opportunity is not readiness.
Readiness is not scale.*

Kenya retail is not a single uniform market signal. The Nairobi/Kiambu retail corridor shows enough evidence for a controlled pilot, but not enough for scale. The market may be ready to test. The operator must still prove it can execute.

That is the MVR distinction: opportunity is not readiness, and readiness is not scale until the relationships and operations both hold.

VERDICT · PILOT_ONLY

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

NOT AUTHORIZED FOR NATIONAL SCALE

African Market OS

Minimum Viable Relationships

The Minimum Viable Relationships framework defines what to assess. The MVR Core API is the official engine that computes it — evidence-led market and relational readiness for African retail corridors.

FRAMEWORK

Minimum Viable Relationships (MVR)

PUBLICATION DATE

2026-05-29

ENGINE

MVR Core API v6.32.0

CONTACT

africanmarketos.com · info@africanmarketos.com